

AI Dungeon: Comprehensive Feature Breakdown & Analysis

I looked through the current AI Dungeon site and its official documentation. The interesting part is that AI Dungeon is much more than “an AI that writes stories.” Its strongest feature is the combination of an open-ended text interface, persistent world/context tools, scenario creation, customization, community content, and actual extensibility through scripting.

| AI Dungeon — Feature Breakdown

1. Open-ended AI Storytelling

The fundamental feature is that there isn't a fixed set of actions you have to choose from. You can type what your character does, says, or what happens next, and the AI generates the continuation. The official documentation explicitly describes the experience as letting players type essentially any action and having the AI attempt to continue the story from it.

Why it's good: * No traditional branching-tree limitation. * Players aren't restricted to developer-authored choices. * The player can effectively act as both player and director. * Unexpected actions can produce unexpected story developments. * The same starting scenario can produce very different adventures.

This is probably the core product insight: the interface is a blank narrative canvas rather than a menu of predefined actions.

2. Four Different Action Modes

AI Dungeon separates player input into different semantic modes: * **Do**: Tell the AI what your character physically does. * **Say**: Tell the AI what your character says. * **Story**: Directly write narrative text yourself rather than asking the AI to interpret it as an action/dialogue. * **See**: Generate an image representing something in the adventure.

This is a very good design decision because it gives the AI additional information about what the player's text means. Instead of "I open the door" being ambiguous, the system knows that this is a Do action. Likewise, dialogue is explicitly differentiated from narration.

Why it's good: It creates a surprisingly simple control language: Do → Say → Story → See. The player doesn't need to learn a complicated RPG interface.

3. AI-Generated Images

The **See** action can generate an image from the current adventure/prompt, directly inside the story. Players can choose an image-generation model, and the system shows the credit cost associated with models. SDXL is available to all players, with additional models available to premium users.

Why it's good: * Turns a text adventure into a partially visual experience. * Images are generated in context rather than being generic illustrations. * The visual component is optional. * It gives long adventures a stronger sense of place and identity.

So the product isn't purely text anymore—it is essentially: AI narrative + AI world simulation + AI illustration.

4. Undo / Redo / Retry / Edit

One of the most important gameplay features is that AI Dungeon doesn't treat the AI's output as immutable. You can: * Undo actions * Redo actions * Retry AI generations * Edit generated text * Erase portions of the adventure

Individual story actions can be edited, undone, redone, or permanently erased.

Why this is excellent for AI: Generative AI inevitably produces bad outputs. Instead of forcing the player to accept them, AI Dungeon treats generation as something you can iterate on. The workflow becomes `Generate → inspect → retry/edit → continue` rather than `Generate → accept whatever happened`. That's an important product philosophy.

5. Persistent Adventures

An Adventure is essentially an individual playthrough/story. It has: Title, Description, Tags, Settings, Story/action history, Plot information, Story Cards, Visibility settings, Images, and AI configuration. Adventures automatically save, so you can leave and come back later. They're also available through My Stuff.

Why it's good: The AI experience isn't disposable. A session becomes a persistent piece of content.

6. Long-Term AI Memory

This is one of AI Dungeon's most interesting technical features. Its Memory System consists primarily of: * **Auto Summarization:** The system automatically creates and updates a summary of the story. That means the AI doesn't have to receive the entire adventure verbatim forever. * **Memory Bank:** The system creates condensed "snapshot" memories of events and retrieves relevant ones when appropriate.

In other words: Story happens → important information is compressed → relevant information gets retrieved later. This is much more sophisticated than simply stuffing the last N messages into a context window.

Why it's good: Long-running AI stories have an enormous problem: the AI forgets things. AI Dungeon explicitly builds product features around solving that problem.

7. Plot Components

Players can manually tell the AI what it needs to know through several different context layers. * **AI Instructions:** Instructions about how the AI should behave (Narrative perspective, Writing style, Rules, Things the AI should emphasize or avoid). * **Story Summary:** A high-level description of what has happened in the story. * **Plot Essentials:** Persistent facts that should remain relevant (Character identity, Important relationships, World rules, Current objectives). * **Author's Note:** Short instructions about Tone, Genre, Style, Pacing, and Immediate narrative direction.

The interesting design choice is that these aren't all treated equally. Some context is always present, while Story Cards can be selectively injected.

8. Story Cards

Story Cards are basically conditional world knowledge. A card can contain Triggers → Information. For example, Trigger: castle → Entry: information about the castle. When the trigger appears in recent story text, the associated information is added to the AI's context. This is effectively a primitive retrieval system for world lore.

Why it's good: You can create huge worlds without putting every fact into the AI's context every turn. Characters, Locations, Factions, Creatures, History, Magic systems, Political organizations, and Items can all have their own cards. This gives creators a way to build a world database around the AI.

9. Context Management

AI Dungeon exposes a surprising amount of control over what the AI actually receives. You can control Context length, Memory, Auto Summary, Story Cards, Plot components, Model settings, and Generated response length. The system also provides Context Viewer / Inspect Input functionality so you can see what was actually sent to the AI. That is particularly useful for advanced creators because an AI's output is often only as good as the context it receives.

10. Multiple AI Models

The player can switch the story-generation model used for an adventure. Different models can have different characteristics, and AI Dungeon can expose multiple versions/variants. There are also model-specific context limitations.

Why it's good: Instead of the entire application being tied permanently to one model, AI Dungeon can evolve its model lineup independently. It also lets players prioritize different characteristics such as Quality, Speed, Creativity, Context size, and Cost.

11. Advanced Generation Controls

AI Dungeon exposes the underlying generation controls. These include Response Length, Temperature, Top-K, Top-P, Presence Penalty, Frequency Penalty, and Context Length. This is unusually powerful for a consumer-facing storytelling product.

Why it's good: Casual players can ignore these entirely, while advanced users can tune the AI substantially. That's a nice simple interface → expert controls underneath architecture.

12. Scenario System

A Scenario is a reusable template for an Adventure. A Scenario can define Starting prompt, Plot Essentials, AI Instructions, Story Cards, Author's Note, Placeholders, Rating, Tags, Scripting, and Visibility. Someone can create a Scenario once and other players can use it to start their own independent Adventures.

Why it's good: It separates *Content template* from *individual playthrough*. That's extremely useful for community-generated experiences.

13. Scenario Placeholders

Creators can make scenarios ask players questions when they start (e.g., What's your character's name? What's your profession? Where are you from?). The answers can then be inserted into the scenario. This makes a single scenario reusable for many different players.

14. Character Creator Scenarios

AI Dungeon has a dedicated Character Creator Scenario type. Players can select combinations of Story Cards representing aspects of their character (Race, Class, Faction, Background). The system can then generate an opening based on those selections. This is a clever way of creating combinatorial content. Instead of writing 100 different introductions manually, the creator defines components and lets the AI assemble an appropriate beginning.

15. Multiple Choice Scenarios

Creators can also make Multiple Choice Scenarios. These can contain Choices, Sub-scenarios, Further choices, and Branching structures. These can have virtually unlimited options and levels of branching. This is essentially a hybrid between traditional branching narrative and generative AI storytelling.

16. Scenario Publishing

Creators can publish their scenarios for other players. Scenarios can be Draft/private, Unlisted, or Published. Published scenarios become discoverable. Creators can continue editing their own drafts without immediately changing the public version.

17. Community Content / Discover

AI Dungeon has a large community-content layer. Players can discover Scenarios, Adventures, and Community-created experiences. The Discover/search system can filter and sort content by things such as Best Match, New, Popular, Trending, Recently Updated, Date range, Rating, Following, Third Person, and Multiplayer. This is important because the product doesn't rely entirely on users inventing their own stories from scratch.

18. Trending System

AI Dungeon changed its Trending system in December 2025. Rather than simply ranking things by raw play count, it attempts to identify content that people actually engage with and continue playing. That's a much better approach for discovery because clicks $\neq$ enjoyment.

19. Adventure Publishing / Sharing

Adventures can be made Private (Only the creator can access them), Unlisted (Accessible through a share link but not discoverable through search), or Published (Publicly discoverable). This creates a useful spectrum between personal diary → private sharing → public content.

20. Multiplayer

AI Dungeon supports multiplayer adventures. Players can invite others using a generated join code. Other players appear in the game and can participate in the same AI-generated story. There are also multiplayer management controls such as Invite players, Kick players, Block players. The Third Person feature is particularly useful here because each participant can have their own character name rather than everyone being interpreted as "you." This turns the system into something closer to AI-powered tabletop roleplaying rather than simply a single-player story generator.

21. Scripting

This is probably the most powerful feature for advanced creators. Creators can write JavaScript that modifies the Scenario's behavior. There are four script areas: Library, Input, Context, Output. The scripting lifecycle lets creators modify Input (What the player entered), Context (What is sent to the AI), Output (What comes back from the AI). Scripts can also maintain persistent state.

22. Scriptable Game Mechanics

This makes AI Dungeon much more than an AI writing interface. Community scripts have been used for things such as Dice rolls, Stats, RPG mechanics, Relationship tracking, Random events, Story arcs, Automatic Story Cards, Custom UI behavior, and Narrative guidance. This means creators can essentially build a game on top of the AI narrative engine. That's a huge capability.

23. Script Testing / Debugging

Creators aren't expected to blindly deploy scripts. The scripting interface includes a Script Test environment. You can provide test input and inspect things such as Returned text, Stop state, Logs, Updated state, and Story Cards. There's also an inspect facility for looking at model context/game state. That's a surprisingly developer-friendly feature for a storytelling platform.

24. Custom Images

Adventures and scenarios can have images/covers. Creators can also upload custom images. The system has image-content rating as part of its publishing process. This helps community content feel more like an actual game/content library rather than a collection of text prompts.

25. Custom Themes

The game interface itself is customizable. Current documented themes include Dynamic, Colorful, Orcish, Atlantis, S'mores, and Cyber. There are also different text styles such as Print, Clean, Hacker. The Colorful mode can dynamically use colors derived from content imagery. That's a nice little immersion feature.

26. Accessibility Controls

AI Dungeon includes High Contrast, Text size options, Text animation toggle, Large/larger text, Compact buttons, and Sticky input behavior. These are particularly useful because the core product involves a lot of reading and typing.

27. Mobile Support

AI Dungeon works on Desktop browsers, Mobile browsers, iOS, and Android. The cloud-based architecture means adventures can follow the account between devices.

28. Cloud-Saved Adventures

Your Adventures and Scenarios are stored in the cloud and associated with your account. That means you can switch devices and continue your stories.

29. My Stuff

My Stuff acts as the user's personal content library. It contains things such as Adventures, Scenarios, and Other created content. You can return to previous stories and continue/edit them. This sounds basic, but it's essential for a product where stories can become extremely long.

30. Search

Search isn't just a simple text search. You can search for content and filter by Content type, Match, New, Popular, Trending, Recently Updated, Time period, Content rating, Following, Multiplayer, and Third Person. That makes the community library much more navigable.

31. Content Ratings and Safety Controls

AI Dungeon has separate controls for generated content and discovery/search content. The AI safety system has Safe, Moderate, and Mature. Community/discovery content can have ratings such as Everyone, Teen, Mature, and Unrated. This separation is smart because someone's personal generation preferences don't necessarily need to determine what they see while browsing community content.

32. Raw Model Output

For advanced users, AI Dungeon can expose the model's raw output rather than processing it to cleanly terminate unfinished sentences. This is particularly useful for experimentation/debugging.

33. AI Improvement / Experimentation

There's an Improve the AI opt-in system. Players can opt into experiments involving model evaluation and A/B testing, with the documentation noting that this also opts the player into Dataset Publication. This allows the product to use real gameplay feedback to improve future models.

34. Deprecated Model Support

There is even a setting to expose deprecated models temporarily before they're removed completely. That's an unusually nice feature for power users who want compatibility with older adventures or simply want to compare models.

35. Context Inspection

You can inspect what the AI actually received. The context can contain things like Instructions, Memory, Story Summary, Story Cards, Author's Note, Recent actions, and Player input. The interface can show this through its inspection/context tools.

Why this matters: This addresses one of the biggest problems with AI applications: "Why did the AI do that?" Often the answer is: "Because this is what we actually sent the model." AI Dungeon gives advanced users visibility into that.

36. Credits and Scales

AI Dungeon has two internal currencies: * **Credits:** Premium currency associated with AI/image/context usage and subscriptions. * **Scales:** A softer currency that can be earned through things such as daily login rewards or received as tips, and can be used for certain functionality such as speeding up free models.

This gives the platform a way to balance expensive AI inference against free usage.

37. Free-to-play

The basic AI Dungeon experience is available for free. Free users get access to the fundamental gameplay features, while subscriptions provide additional capabilities. This is important because the core experience has a very low barrier to entry: Open → choose a scenario → start writing.

38. Cross-device Experience

Because the adventures are cloud-hosted and tied to the account, the same content can be accessed across devices. This is particularly valuable for something that is fundamentally a persistent digital notebook/story/game.

39. Community Ecosystem

AI Dungeon also has an official community/Discord where players and developers interact, share scripts, discuss models, troubleshoot adventures, and exchange advice. That makes the product more extensible because knowledge isn't restricted to official documentation.

| The Really Good Parts

If I were analyzing AI Dungeon as a product rather than merely listing features, I'd say its biggest strengths are these:

1. It makes AI feel like a game

Instead of "Write me a fantasy story", the interaction is: `You do something → AI reacts → you respond → AI reacts again`. That's much more engaging.

2. It gives the player control without requiring traditional game development

Traditional RPGs need developers to anticipate: "What might the player do?" AI Dungeon flips that: "Tell us what the player does, and we'll try to handle it." That's an enormous expansion of the possible interaction space.

3. It solves AI's memory problem with multiple layers

This is arguably the strongest technical architecture: `Recent story ↓ Plot Essentials ↓ Story Summary ↓ Story Cards ↓ Memory Bank ↓ AI context`. Rather than expecting one enormous context window to solve everything.

4. It gives creators an actual development stack

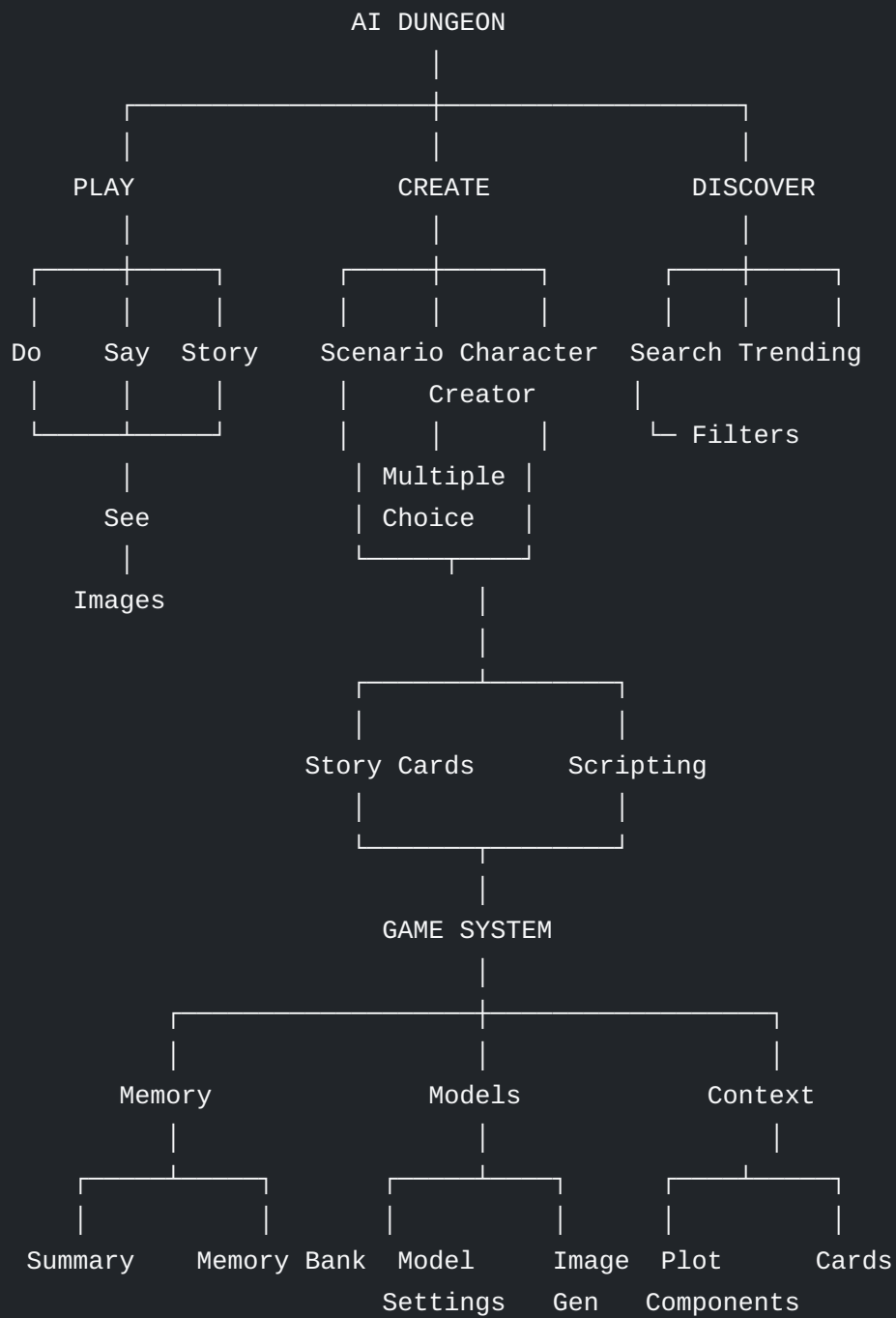
The progression is excellent: * **Beginner**: Write a prompt. * **Intermediate**: Add Plot Essentials and Story Cards. * **Advanced**: Build a Scenario. * **Expert**: Build Character Creators / branching scenarios. * **Developer**: Write JavaScript scripts.

So the same product accommodates both someone who wants to casually play for five minutes and someone who wants to build a sophisticated RPG experience.

5. The AI is editable rather than authoritative

This is perhaps the most important UX philosophy. The AI isn't the "game master who is always right." The player can: `Undo → Retry → Edit → Erase → Continue`. That acknowledges that generative AI is imperfect. Instead of fighting that imperfection, the product makes correction part of the gameplay loop.

The Feature Architecture



What I think is the secret sauce

If you're studying AI Dungeon because you're thinking about building something similar, I wouldn't copy the feature list blindly. The really valuable idea is the stack:

- Freeform input
- AI response
- Player correction
- Persistent state
- Retrievable world knowledge
- Creator-authored scenarios
- Community content
- Scripting
- AI-generated visuals

Each feature reinforces the others. A Scenario gives the AI initial knowledge. Story Cards give it world knowledge. Memory preserves what happened. Model settings control how it responds. Scripts can create game mechanics. Images make the result tangible. Publishing lets other people play it. Discovery creates an ecosystem around those creations.

That's why AI Dungeon is considerably more interesting than a generic "AI story generator."

One caveat: I can give you a very thorough current feature inventory from the official site/docs, but "every feature" can never be guaranteed literally exhaustive because some features are account-tier dependent, experimental, or buried in individual settings/release notes. The official documentation itself is the best source of truth, and I checked the current 2026 material rather than relying on old AI Dungeon descriptions. (aidungeon.com)